

EMPHASIS WEIGHT IN THE PAUSE LADDER

# Narration that knows what matters.

*Every rung of the pause ladder keyed on a glyph or a boundary, so a deck's key claim was  
paced exactly like its footnote.*

01 • THE PROBLEM

# Every beat was the same length.

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- Punctuation set the pause
  - A comma bought 200 ms, a period 550. The glyph decided, never the meaning.
- Boundaries set the rest
  - A paragraph, a slide and a section each got a flat constant.

## KEY INSIGHT

Nothing ever asked which words mattered.

# A bold phrase holds a beat.

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**Net revenue retention reached 118%** — that single number moved the year, so the narration waits before moving on.

- The author pressed the button
  - **\*\*bold\*\*** is the whole signal. No model, no inference.

## KEY INSIGHT

If everything is held, nothing is.

03 • THE CLOSING BEAT

# The coda used to be silent.

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A trailing quote is lifted into its own cell, outside the stage every body walker reads.

- Measured, not guessed
  - 53 of 161 committed decks carry one.
- Spoken, and held
  - The beat lands in the shared webpage, which pauses after the last line too.

## KEY INSIGHT

A slide's punchline was not paced badly. It was missing.

04 • ONE BEAT PER PASSAGE

# A long insight lands once.

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- The cue that ends it holds
  - A passage spanning four sentences gets one beat after it, not four inside it.
- A short phrase is unchanged
  - A bolded claim starts and ends in the same sentence.

## KEY INSIGHT

Holding everything is holding nothing, one sentence at a time.

05 • THE LIMITS

# Best-effort, and never wrong.

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- A repeated phrase is skipped
  - The same words twice, and neither is marked.
- The hold is capped
  - Bolding every line buys no stall.

## KEY INSIGHT

A missed beat sounds like yesterday. A misplaced one sounds like a defect.

# Captions, read-aloud, exported player.

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- One formula, three consumers
  - The estimate, the live Studio and the baked deck space cues identically.
- The hold sits between cues
  - A synthesized clip carries no pause the engine invented.

## KEY INSIGHT

An unweighted deck is timed exactly as it was before any of this existed.